

Clients, Servers, and Routes

FastAPI Masterclass

Clients and Servers I

- The **client** is the computer that initiates a request.
- A **request** is an ask for data.
- The request may come from a web application, a mobile app, a command-line, and more.

Clients and Servers II

- The **server** is the computer that responds to the request, usually with a payload of data.
- **FastAPI** builds the server-side (backend) logic.
- **FastAPI** maps the request to a corresponding route.

Routes and Endpoints

- A **route** is a specific path that the server recognizes and maps to a procedure.
- A server needs to know what resource the client is requesting.
- An **endpoint** is another word for **route**.

Online Store Example

- The **/products** endpoint returns a list of products
- The **/products/42** endpoint returns the details of product #42
- The **/cart** endpoint returns the details of the user's shopping cart

Routes and FastAPI

- The FastAPI model maps a route to a Python function that executes when the endpoint is hit.
- We call these functions **route handler** functions.
- The **/products** route may map to a **get_products** function.